



ENG514

Treasure for Final-Term

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

Maha Malik

Teaching Listening and Speaking Skills

Lecture- 08 Teaching Speaking

Module 23: Speaking Skills

Role of Language

Language serves as a crucial medium for communication, enabling individuals to express ideas, exchange information, and maintain relationships. It plays a central role in cultural transmission and global interactions. English, as the primary global language, is embedded in education systems worldwide and is essential for both academic and professional purposes. Its importance underscores the need to develop proficiency in speaking as a key aspect of language learning.

Speaking Skills

Speaking is one of the four core language skills alongside listening, reading, and writing. It is central to verbal communication, allowing individuals to articulate thoughts and emotions. Speaking involves various components, including pronunciation, fluency, grammar, and pragmatics, which together ensure the delivery of clear and meaningful messages. Mastering speaking skills is essential for achieving effective oral communication and is often seen as a benchmark of language proficiency.

Types of Speaking

Speaking can be categorized into two main types: monologues and dialogues. Monologues involve uninterrupted oral presentations, often used in speeches or lectures. Dialogues, on the other hand, are interactive exchanges between two or more individuals, focusing on communication and collaboration. Additionally, speaking serves two primary functions: transactional, aimed at exchanging information, and interactional, which focuses on building and maintaining social relationships.

Importance of Speaking in ESL/EFL

In the context of English as a Second Language (ESL) or English as a Foreign Language (EFL), speaking is frequently the most utilized skill. It is a key indicator of language proficiency and is integral to academic and professional success. Effective speaking requires a combination of grammatical accuracy, mechanical precision (such as correct pronunciation), and an understanding of social interaction norms. It also demands pragmatics—the ability to use language appropriately in varying contexts.

Cognitive and Planning Aspects

Speaking is a complex cognitive activity that involves retrieving words, phrases, and ideas from memory and organizing them into coherent sentences. It requires real-time processing, making it more demanding than other language activities. Planning is an essential part of speaking, as it helps in structuring thoughts and maintaining fluency, particularly in more formal or transactional contexts.

Module 24: Teaching Speaking

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Introduction to Speaking and Teaching Contexts

Speaking, an essential language skill, involves both social and cognitive dimensions. It includes the production of sounds, words, and sentences to convey meaning in various contexts. The teaching of speaking has evolved over time, influenced by societal and educational demands. Historically, speaking was associated with persuasion and rhetoric, whereas contemporary approaches emphasize communicative competence in real-life scenarios.

Historical Perspectives on Speaking

Over centuries, attitudes toward teaching speaking have shifted. Earlier methods, such as the grammar-translation approach, focused more on written language. With the advent of the Reform Movement in the late 19th century, the importance of speech gained prominence. The communicative approach of the 1970s further reinforced the necessity of teaching speaking as a practical skill.

Guidelines for Presenting Formal Talks

Teaching formal speaking, such as giving speeches or presentations, involves several key strategies:

- ❖ Limit the message to three or four main points for clarity.
- ❖ Structure the talk with an outline, either presented initially or built progressively.
- ❖ Incorporate changes in focus to maintain audience interest, such as visual aids or interactive elements.
- ❖ Involve the audience through questions and feedback to ensure engagement and improve comprehension.

Monitoring and Improving Formal Speaking

Learners benefit from monitoring their speaking performance. Teachers and peers can analyze strengths and areas for improvement during formal talks. Self-reflection is encouraged, enabling learners to identify personal challenges and work on them. While formal monologues are essential, interactive conversations remain a critical part of speaking competence.

Module 25: Teaching Speaking - Pronunciation II

Factors in Learning a New Sound System

Teaching pronunciation involves addressing various aspects of speech, including the articulation of sounds, stress, and intonation. Pronunciation learning is influenced by multiple factors such as the learner's first language, mimicry abilities, and prior exposure to the target language. Teachers play a crucial role in designing techniques to improve pronunciation by focusing on individual sounds, stress patterns, and intonation.

Articulation of Individual Sounds

Effective pronunciation teaching begins with diagnosing specific issues in learners' speech. This process includes:

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- ❖ Identifying whether the target sound exists in the learner's first language.
- ❖ Analyzing substitutions made by learners for the desired sound.
- ❖ Assessing the positions (initial, medial, or final) where errors occur.

Teachers then guide learners in distinguishing and identifying the target sound, progressing from imitation to more active correction techniques. Visual aids, such as mirrors, are employed to help learners observe and adjust their articulation.

Teaching Stress and Intonation

Stress in English often depends on word type and sentence meaning. Techniques to teach stress include:

- ❖ Tapping stress patterns for learners to mimic.
- ❖ Grouping words based on their stress patterns for practice.

Intonation is another critical aspect, guiding learners to follow patterns like rising intonation in yes/no questions or falling intonation in declarative sentences. Visual representations and gestures help learners understand and replicate intonation changes.

Techniques and Procedures

Teachers use a variety of techniques to enhance learners' pronunciation. These include:

- ❖ Observation and analysis of sound errors.
- ❖ Explanation of tongue and lip positions for specific sounds.
- ❖ Encouraging experimentation with sound production, emphasizing self-awareness of articulation positions.

This module underscores the importance of structured pronunciation practices, using targeted techniques to address learner-specific challenges while fostering their ability to experiment and self-correct.

Lecture- 09 Learning Through Task-focused Interaction

Module 26: Interactive Listening and Speaking

Interactive Listening Tasks

Interactive listening involves engaging in face-to-face interactions where learners alternate between being speakers and listeners. These tasks allow learners to seek clarifications, improve comprehension, and actively participate in conversations. Two main types of interaction occur:

- ❖ **Interactional Talk:** Focused on building and maintaining relationships, with shorter, evenly distributed turns.
- ❖ **Transactional Talk:** Aimed at exchanging information, where one speaker dominates while listeners ask questions or provide comments.

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The combination of these talks reflects real-life communication, enhancing mutual understanding and cooperation among participants.

Developing Process-Based Modules from Listening Tasks

To make listening purposeful and directed, tasks should include pre- and post-listening activities:

- ❖ **Pre-listening Activities:** Prepare learners by activating prior knowledge or introducing new schema, making the listening input easier to process.
- ❖ **Post-listening Activities:** Extend communicative outcomes and help learners notice language features in the input for further language acquisition.

These modules often involve metacognitive activities, such as strategy use and reflection, which help learners manage comprehension and improve their listening skills.

Integrating Listening and Speaking

Interactive tasks integrate listening and speaking skills, requiring learners to collaborate and achieve shared goals. Activities often feature knowledge gaps that participants must fill, promoting active engagement and practical language use.

This module emphasizes the importance of integrating listening and speaking in language learning through task-focused interactions, fostering both comprehension and communication skills.

Module 27: Learning Through Task-Focused Interaction - II

Using Learner Training to Encourage Negotiation

Learner training is essential to develop negotiation skills, which are vital for effective communication. Negotiation strategies include asking for clarifications, requesting repetitions, and slowing the discourse to resolve comprehension issues. Structured procedures, such as interview preparation, transcription analysis, and seminar presentations, help learners improve their interaction skills. These tasks enhance their awareness of linguistic and sociolinguistic aspects of spoken language.

Stages of Training

- ❖ **Preparation:** Focus on appropriate addressing styles and discourse management strategies.
- ❖ **Transcription:** Analyze and understand recorded interviews, identifying strengths and weaknesses.
- ❖ **Presentation:** Share findings with peers through seminar-style discussions, receiving feedback.

Techniques for Managing Interaction

Learners can control interactions by using phrases like “Please speak more slowly” or “Could you repeat that?” Such techniques empower students to manage conversations, turning listening exercises into learning opportunities. The teacher plays a supportive role by providing useful sentences and ensuring practice.

Interactive Activities

Activities like "picture drawing in pairs" or "controlling the teacher" are designed to encourage negotiation and improve comprehension. These tasks require learners to request clarifications and confirmations, fostering interactive communication.

Significance of Negotiation

Negotiation not only enhances language proficiency but also deepens learners' understanding of discourse. The focus on interaction encourages students to bridge knowledge gaps and refine their communication strategies effectively.

Lecture- 10 Learning Through Pushed Output

Module 28: Learning Through Pushed Output - I

Introduction to Pushed Output

Pushed output refers to the process where learners are encouraged to produce language beyond their current comfort zone. Unlike comprehension-focused approaches, pushed output emphasizes speaking and writing to strengthen language acquisition. This process allows learners to refine their linguistic skills by confronting their limitations and actively seeking ways to improve.

Techniques for Pushed Output

To engage learners in pushed output, teachers employ strategies that compel learners to use new language forms and expand their expressive abilities. Common activities include information gap tasks, pair discussions, and story retelling, which require learners to formulate ideas and construct sentences in real-time.

The Role of Fluency

Fluency development is integral to pushed output. Activities like 4/3/2 exercises (where learners repeat the same content to different audiences with progressively reduced time limits) help improve fluency by emphasizing repetition and speed. These exercises encourage learners to internalize language structures and use them effectively.

Impact on Language Learning

Pushed output aids learners in noticing gaps in their knowledge and motivates them to seek resources or clarification. This self-awareness fosters autonomous learning and accelerates linguistic competence. It also provides opportunities for immediate feedback from peers or instructors, reinforcing correct usage.

Challenges and Teacher Support

Learners may face challenges such as anxiety or reluctance to participate in pushed output tasks. Teachers can address these by creating a supportive environment, offering constructive feedback, and designing tasks that match learners' proficiency levels.

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This module highlights the importance of integrating pushed output activities into language learning to enhance fluency, accuracy, and overall communicative competence.

Module 29: Learning Through Pushed Output - II

The Nature of Formal Speaking

Formal speaking tasks, such as presenting reports or viewpoints, differ from casual interactional speaking in several ways. These tasks are transactional, focusing on the exchange of information rather than maintaining social contact. Formal speaking involves taking a "long turn," requiring structured, organized, and deliberate speech often influenced by written language. Learners must utilize academic vocabulary and careful articulation to ensure clarity. This type of speaking often requires direct teaching as it is not a natural part of everyday language use.

Teaching Formal Speaking

Formal speaking is best taught by focusing on its transactional purpose—communicating information effectively. Classroom setups should support this goal, such as arranging the audience in rows or a horseshoe shape. Students can prepare and deliver talks in front of peers, either as standalone presentations or debates, with opportunities for questions and feedback. Emphasis should be placed on delivering talks from short notes rather than reading from fully written scripts to enhance fluency and engagement.

Guidelines for Formal Talks

- ❖ **Message Limitation:** Focus on 3-4 key points to ensure clarity and audience retention.
- ❖ **Outline Presentation:** Provide a simple outline at the beginning or progressively build it during the talk to maintain audience attention.
- ❖ **Audience Involvement:** Encourage questions and feedback to enhance interaction, improve the quality of information, and assess comprehension.
- ❖ **Focus Shifts:** Introduce periodic changes, such as visuals or audience participation, to sustain interest and provide breaks in attention.

Monitoring Formal Talks

Teachers and learners can evaluate formal talks by identifying strengths and areas for improvement. Reflecting on performance helps students recognize their progress and address challenges. Additionally, activities like conversational storytelling and structured presentations can further enhance long-turn speaking skills.

This module emphasizes formal speaking as a critical skill for academic and professional success, highlighting strategies to develop structured, fluent, and audience-focused presentations.

Lecture- 11 Language-focused Learning: Deliberate Teaching

Module 30: Language-Focused Learning - Deliberate Teaching

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Introduction to Language-Focused Learning

Language-focused learning involves directing attention to language features, not just for their communicative meaning but also for their form, usage, and patterns. This approach is essential for reinforcing learners' understanding of the language as a system. Unlike purely meaning-focused instruction, language-focused learning involves deliberate noticing of linguistic items, which can help integrate them into a learner's broader language system.

Value of Language-Focused Learning

This learning method provides significant benefits, including:

- ❖ Accelerated second language acquisition when combined with meaning-focused use.
- ❖ Enhanced control over grammar, helping learners reduce persistent errors.
- ❖ Direct contributions to acquisition, especially for vocabulary.
- ❖ Indirect support for meaning-focused instruction through structured language practice.

Limitations of Language-Focused Learning

Despite its benefits, there are some limitations:

- ❖ It cannot change the natural order of acquiring certain complex features like negatives or relative clauses.
- ❖ Its effectiveness depends on the learners' ability to connect focused learning to real-life usage.

Teacher's Role and Methods

Teachers guide learners to notice and process language items through explicit instruction or carefully designed activities. This can include tasks such as:

- ❖ Highlighting grammatical structures during reading or listening tasks.
- ❖ Encouraging deliberate practice of vocabulary or sentence patterns.

This module emphasizes a balanced approach, where language-focused learning complements meaning-focused activities to maximize language acquisition.

Module 31: Language-Focused Learning: Deliberate Teaching II

Deliberate Grammar Learning:

- ❖ Grammar can be learned explicitly through direct explanation, exercises, consciousness-raising activities, and feedback.
- ❖ Such learning emphasizes understanding grammatical features, their use, and construction.

Advantages of Direct Teaching:

- ❖ Direct explanation of grammar points saves time, allowing more focus on practice and meaningful application.

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- ❖ Studies (e.g., Sheen, 1992) suggest direct teaching is advantageous, especially in oral assessments, as it provides time for practical reinforcement.

Grammar-focused Description:

- ❖ Teachers can explain rules or patterns clearly to help learners understand grammar.

Techniques include:

- ❖ **Direct explanations:** Quickly conveying key points.
- ❖ **Examples and exercises:** Helping learners manipulate and join grammatical constructs.

Exploring Collocation Patterns:

- ❖ Describing collocation possibilities (e.g., specific phrases that pair naturally) is practical for learners and enhances understanding.

Learning Explicit Grammatical Rules:

The module discusses various exercise types for teaching grammar:

- ❖ **Transformation exercises:** Combining sentences to form more complex structures.
- ❖ **Classification tasks:** Grouping similar grammar constructs.

Integration of meaning-focused and form-focused tasks is highlighted to create a balanced learning approach.

Empirical Support:

Research supports a combination of explicit grammar teaching with practical tasks to ensure learners develop both theoretical understanding and practical application skills.

This module advocates for a structured, teacher-guided approach to grammar learning, balancing explanation with interactive and meaningful practice.

Lecture- 12 Developing Fluency

Definition of Fluency

- ❖ Involves real-time processing of language in listening, speaking, reading, and writing.
- ❖ Characteristics include speed, ease, and minimal pauses during communication.

Fluency vs. Accuracy:

- ❖ Fluency activities enhance speed and reduce hesitation, while accuracy focuses on minimizing errors.
- ❖ Both aspects can improve simultaneously when properly integrated.

Fluency Development Techniques:

- ❖ **Message-Focused Activities:** Tasks that emphasize communication over grammar.
- ❖ **Repetition:** Practicing the same material repeatedly to build confidence and speed.

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- ❖ **Skill Integration:** Linking activities (e.g., reading followed by speaking) to reinforce fluency.

Module 32: Vocabulary Teaching and Learning

Balanced Approach:

- ❖ Emphasizes a combination of deliberate vocabulary learning and meaning-focused use.
- ❖ Vocabulary learning should be reinforced through practice in input (listening, reading) and output (speaking, writing).

Techniques for Effective Vocabulary Learning:

- ❖ **Semantic Mapping:** Creating connections between new words and existing knowledge.
- ❖ **Mnemonic Devices:** Using techniques like keyword strategies to link form and meaning effectively.
- ❖ **Vocabulary Cards:** Writing words on small cards with translations and phrases for review.
- ❖ **Guided Guessing:** Encouraging learners to deduce meanings from context, using situational and linguistic clues.

Different Learning Stages:

- ❖ **Beginners:** Focus on expanding vocabulary rapidly through pre-teaching, simple definitions, and direct explanations.
- ❖ **Intermediate:** Shift to analyzing word usage in varied contexts and deducing meanings using linguistic clues.
- ❖ **Advanced:** Build on foundational vocabulary, emphasizing low-frequency words and advanced strategies like contextual inference.

Avoiding Interference:

Avoid teaching near-synonyms, opposites, or closely related lexical sets together to reduce confusion.

Integration into Language Use:

Words learned should be actively used in fluency-building activities and real-life communication to ensure retention and practical application.

This module underscores the importance of thoughtful design in vocabulary instruction to ensure learners can use words fluently and effectively in communication.

Module 33: Developing Fluency

- ❖ Fluency involves smooth, rapid, and confident language use.
- ❖ Activities like repetition, timed tasks, and integration of listening and speaking promote fluency.
- ❖ Controlled input ensures learners focus on message delivery rather than language form.

Lecture- 13 Teaching Speaking and Listening in Primary School

Fluency in Listening:

- ❖ Use of familiar topics and simple tasks to support comprehension.
- ❖ Activities include listening to stories, puzzles, and quizzes with clear outcomes.

Fluency in Speaking:

Techniques such as the 4/3/2 Activity:

- ❖ Learners speak on a topic for 4 minutes, then repeat to new listeners in 3 and 2 minutes, respectively.
- ❖ Encourages mastery and quick retrieval of ideas.

Designing Fluency Activities:

- ❖ **Controlled Input:** Using simplified materials for listening and speaking.
- ❖ **Meaning-Focused Repetition:** Encourages learners to focus on communication despite repeated tasks.
- ❖ **Time Pressure:** Reducing task completion time to challenge learners.

Module 34: Fluency in Listening and Speaking

- ❖ Listening: Activities like storytelling and predicting outcomes aid comprehension and fluency.
- ❖ Speaking: Techniques like the 4/3/2 activity reduce preparation time and increase speech speed.
- ❖ Emphasizes the integration of both skills in tasks for practical learning.

Module 35: Testing Speaking

- ❖ Principles include validity, reliability, and practicality.
- ❖ Formats range from role-playing to conversational cloze.
- ❖ Evaluates speaking using rubrics that measure fluency, complexity, and coherence.

Module 36: Researching Speaking

- ❖ Covers both quantitative (speech rate, errors) and qualitative (discourse analysis) research methods.
- ❖ Examines cultural variations in speaking and the effects of teaching techniques.
- ❖ Mixed methods offer comprehensive insights into speaking behaviors.

Module 37: Interactive Listening Tasks

- ❖ Interactive tasks mimic real-life scenarios, alternating between speaking and listening.
- ❖ Tasks include knowledge-gap activities that require collaboration to solve problems.
- ❖ Focus is on creating meaningful communication rather than isolated listening.

Lecture- 14 Assessing Speaking

Principles of Speaking Tests:

- ❖ **Validity:** The test should measure the intended speaking ability.
- ❖ **Reliability:** Scores should be consistent across evaluators and contexts.
- ❖ **Practicality:** Tests should be feasible to administer and grade.

Formats for Speaking Tests:

- ❖ **Role-Playing:** Learners act out scenarios and are scored on fluency and accuracy.
- ❖ **Conversational Cloze:** Filling in blanks in dialogues to measure comprehension.
- ❖ **Imitation and Story Retelling:** Assessing recall and reproduction of spoken input.

Evaluating Speaking:

- ❖ Uses a combination of scales, checklists, and rubrics to assess fluency, accuracy, and complexity.

Module 38: Developing Listening Modules

- ❖ Modules are built around themes, incorporating pre- and post-listening activities.
- ❖ Pre-listening activates prior knowledge, while post-listening extends learning and reflection.
- ❖ Emphasizes metacognitive strategies for active comprehension.

Module 39: Teaching Extensive Listening

- ❖ Encourages listening to engaging content such as stories or songs.
- ❖ Provides low-stakes exposure to natural speech, focusing on overall comprehension rather than detail.
- ❖ Useful for building learner confidence in real-world listening scenarios.

Module 40: Teaching Academic Listening

- ❖ Academic listening involves note-taking, comprehension of lectures, and collaborative discussions.
- ❖ Emphasizes integration of visual aids, background knowledge, and pre-listening preparation.
- ❖ Builds autonomy by encouraging self-directed study.

Lecture- 15 Researching Speaking

Research Paradigms:

Quantitative Approaches:

- ❖ Focus on measurable data, such as speech rate and error count.
- ❖ Use experiments and statistical analysis for generalizable findings.

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Qualitative Approaches:

- ❖ Analyze real conversations to understand patterns and context-specific behaviors.
- ❖ Techniques like conversation analysis (CA) explore social interaction dynamics.

Mixed Methods:

- ❖ Combining quantitative and qualitative methods for a holistic understanding of speaking behaviors.

Key Focus Areas in Research:

- ❖ Investigating pauses, speech patterns, and cross-cultural differences.
- ❖ Exploring the impact of teaching methods on speaking fluency and accuracy.

Module 41: Pronunciation and Intonation

- ❖ Highlights the role of stress, rhythm, and intonation in effective communication.
- ❖ Techniques include minimal pair practice and shadowing exercises.
- ❖ Encourages learners to focus on natural speech patterns for clarity.

Module 42: Online Listening and Speaking Resources

- ❖ Discusses using online platforms for practicing listening and speaking.
- ❖ Highlights the importance of appropriate, interactive content.
- ❖ Examples include podcasts, video tutorials, and virtual role-playing.

Module 43: Advanced Speaking Tasks

- ❖ Focus on formal speaking tasks such as presentations, debates, and interviews.
- ❖ Encourages structured preparation using brainstorming and information schematics.
- ❖ Feedback is vital to refine delivery and improve performance.

Module 44: Speaking as a Social Activity

- ❖ Dialogic teaching promotes learning through group discussions and debates.
- ❖ Guided reading integrates speaking tasks, encouraging social learning.
- ❖ Social interaction strengthens both comprehension and expressive abilities.

Module 45: Using Technology in Listening and Speaking

- ❖ Explores tools like speech recognition, text-to-speech software, and pronunciation apps.
- ❖ Emphasizes incorporating multimedia resources for enhanced learning.
- ❖ Technology facilitates self-paced and interactive language practice.

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Compilation